

AI Grand Prix



AI GP

TM

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About

Conceived by Anduril founder Palmer Luckey, the AI Grand Prix is an open challenge to the boldest engineers from around the globe, in or out of universities.

No human pilots or hardware modifications will be allowed. The competitive edge is gained entirely by optimizing the best code for the race.

The Stakes

**\$500K
Prize Pool**

**Win a Job
at Anduril**

[Official Rules](#)

Challenge

Operations & Hardware

Operated By
Drone Racing League



Hardware By
Neros



Competitors will race fully autonomous, identical drones built by Neros Technologies, incorporating DCL’s AI vector module. All drones will be provided by the AI Grand Prix. Technical specifications will be shared at a later stage.

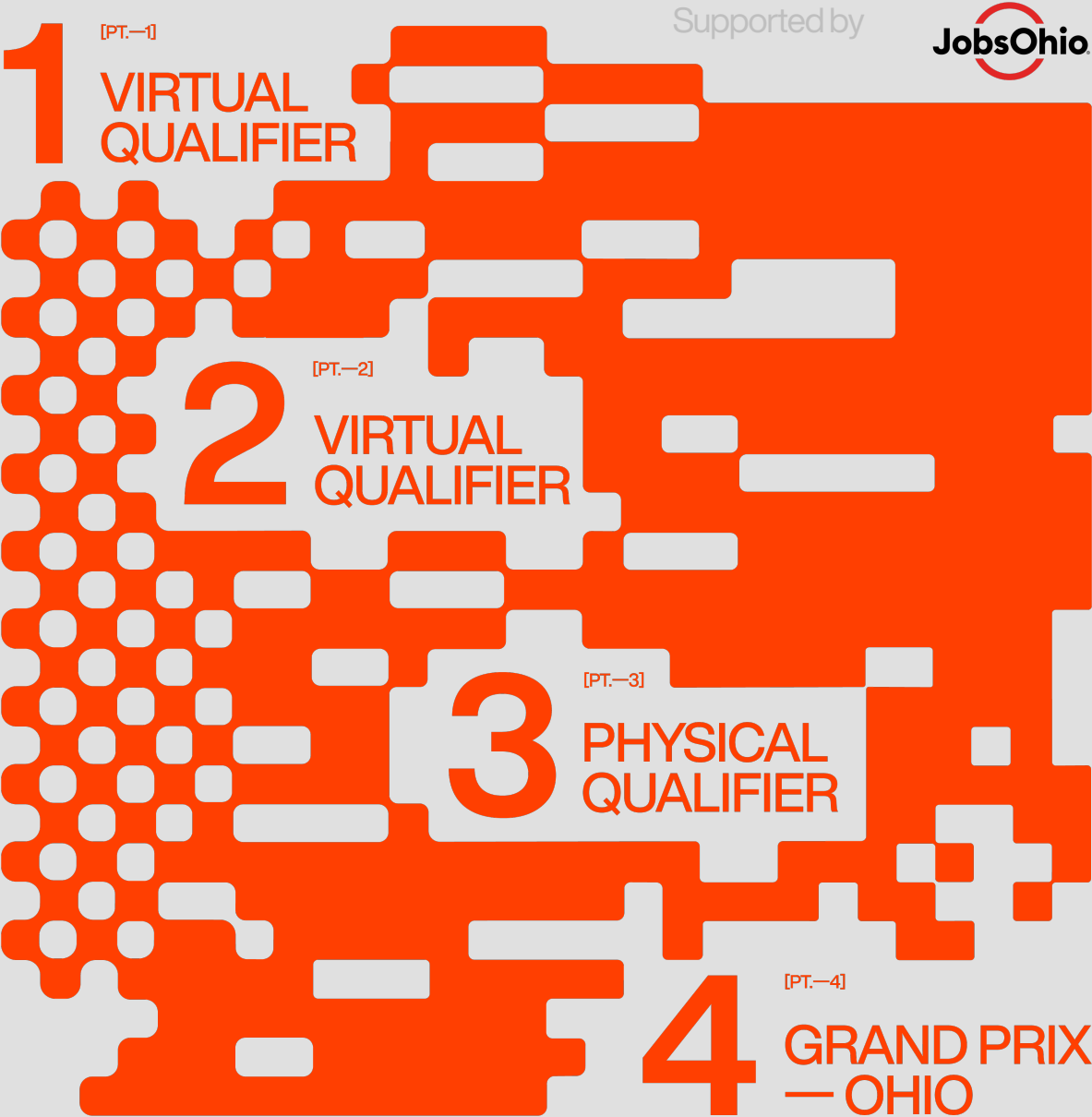
When & Where

The competition kicks off with a virtual competition in April–June, where teams from around the globe will submit their custom Python-based AI algorithms into a DCL-built platform and take on a challenging virtual racecourse.

Top-performing teams will then advance to an exclusive, two-week, in-person training and qualification experience in September 2026 in Southern California—bringing the competition from a simulation to the real world.

Season 1 culminates with the AI Grand Prix in Ohio, where the world’s best will compete on the biggest stage for \$500,000 and to win a job at Anduril.

[Terms & Conditions Apply](#)



Supported by JobsOhio

Application & Selection Process

Who can participate and how to register?

Registration is open to individuals, university teams, research organizations and those with a passion for AI programming. No professional credentials or certifications are required.

Is there an age restriction to sign up?

All ages are allowed, but parents / guardians must register for any interested parties below the age of 14. Written parental consent and age verification will be required for all minors.

Are teams allowed to apply?

Participants can compete as individuals or as teams of up to 8 people. For teams, the team leader should register at this stage. More information on additional team members to be collected post registration.

How do the Virtual Qualifiers work?

Participants are expected to generate a PYTHON-based code set, that is able to fly a digital drone through a 3D-course, containing several gates. All gates need to be passed in the correct order and in the lowest possible time. Your AI should employ classical drone flying commands, such as: Throttle, Roll, Pitch, and Yaw. Using only general telemetry data and visual data from the simulator as input. Flight path optimization, robustness of the laptime etc. are all for the team to decide.

FAQ

Does AI Grand Prix cover flights, accommodations, or other expenses?

No. Each participating team is responsible for covering its own expenses related to the AI Grand Prix, including travel, accommodations, and any additional costs incurred. The Top 10 performing teams at the AI Grand Prix Ohio will be guaranteed a cash prize of at least \$5,000.

What does “Win a Job at Anduril” mean?

Winning a job implies one role at Anduril for the 2026 competition season. Standard work eligibility requirements apply. Winning participants can select an alternative cash bonus if they do not meet the necessary eligibility requirements, choose not to pursue a job at Anduril, or if another team member from the winning team is hired. Additionally, top university performers that reach the physical qualifier stage in Southern California will be screened in person for potential internship and full-time entry-level roles at Anduril.

Who owns the code produced by teams?

Participants retain ownership of their algorithm, source code, and associated documentation both during and after the competition period. By submitting the Entry, Participants hereby grant the AI Grand Prix and its Founding Partners permission to use the Entry for the purposes of operating, monitoring and judging the competition. This access will be restricted to the period in which a given team is still competing ending no later than the closeout activities of the final AI Grand Prix competition stage in 2026. The Entry will only be used for the AI Grand Prix and not be replicated into any systems not necessary for Competition requirements.